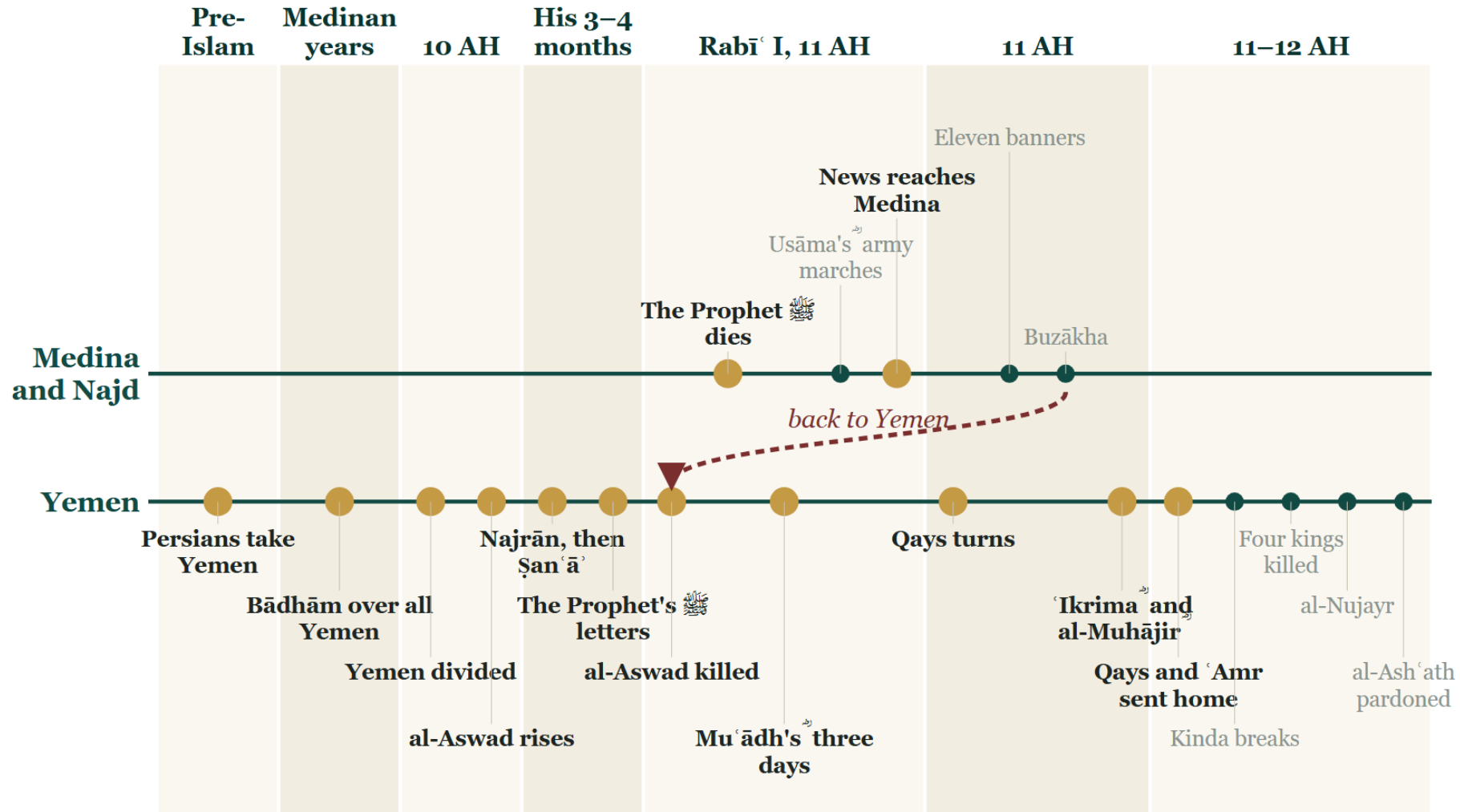


Evening 4

al-Buṭāḥ and al-Yamāma

10–12 AH

Where we stopped



From last week

Where we stand



| **Ṣan'ā'**
restored

| **Ḥaḍramawt**
still to come

Part I

The two claimants still standing (10–12 AH)

Where the story stands

Tonight: back to the north

Evening 2

Khālīd ُ at Buzākha, in
Najd: Ṭulayḥa walked
off the field

Evening 3

The south: al-Aswad
killed in Ṣan‘ā’, the
Yemen restored;
Ḥaḍramawt still to
come

Tonight

Two claimants still
standing in the north:
Musaylima at al-
Yamāma, and Sajāḥ

End of 10 AH

Musaylima's letter, and the reply

فَإِنَّ الْأَرْضَ لِلَّهِ يُورِثُهَا مَنْ يَشَاءُ مِنْ عِبَادِهِ وَالْعَاقِبَةُ لِلْمُتَّقِينَ

...the earth belongs to Allah; He gives it in inheritance to whomever He wills of His servants; and the outcome is for those who fear Him.

al-Bidaya wa'l-Nihaya, vol. 5, p. 24

in the Prophet's ﷺ lifetime

Musaylima at Medina

لو سألتني هذه القطعة ما أعطيتها

If you asked me for this piece, I would not give it to you...

"A liar of Rabī'a"

فقال أشهد أنَّكَ كَذَّابٌ وَأَنَّ مُحَمَّدًا صَادِقٌ، وَلَكِنْ كَذَّابَ رَبِيعَةَ أَحَبُّ إِلَيْنَا مِنْ

صَادِقِ مُضَرَ

He said: I bear witness that you are a liar and that Muḥammad ﷺ is truthful — but a liar of Rabī'a is dearer to us than a truthful man of Muḍar.

Sajāḥ comes down from the north



al-Jazīra

where she came from

al-Yamāma

where she turned back

Sajāḥ — who she actually was

إِذْ أَقْبَلَتْ سَجَاحٌ . . . التَّغْلِبِيَّةُ مِنَ الْجَزِيرَةِ، وَهِيَ مِنْ نَصَارَى الْعَرَبِ، وَقَدْ ادَّعَتْ
النَّبُوَّةَ

...Sajāḥ ... al-Taghlibiyya came forward from al-Jazīra — and she was of the Christians of the Arabs — having claimed prophethood.

11 AH, and afterwards

What her claim was worth

فَكَرَّتْ رَاجِعَةً إِلَى الْجَزِيرَةِ بَعْدَمَا قَبِضَتْ مِنْ مَسَيْلِمَةَ نَصْفَ خَرَجِ

أَرْضِهِ

...she went back to al-Jazīra after she had taken from Musaylima half the kharāj of his land...

al-Bidaya wa'l-Nihaya, vol. 7, p. 30

al-Yamāma before the army came



Ḥajr
the town

Thumāma^٢
of Banū Ḥanīfa itself

11 AH, before Khālid   arrived

There were Muslims inside already

فَخَافَ إِنْ هُوَ شُغِلَ بِهَا أَنْ يَغْلِبَ ثُمَامَةُ وَشُرْحَبِيلُ بْنُ حَسَنَةَ وَالْقَبَائِلُ الَّتِي
حَوْلَهُمْ عَلَى حَجْرٍ، وَهِيَ الْيَمَامَةُ

"He feared that if he were occupied with her, Thumāma and Shuraḥbīl b. Ḥasana and the tribes around them would overcome Ḥajr — which is al-Yamāma."

al-Kamil, vol. 2, p. 210

Part II

al-Buṭāḥ, and the reckoning at Medina (11 AH)

11 AH

After Buzākha

The orders

Tied at Dhū al-Qaṣṣa:
Ṭulayḥa first; when
done, Mālīk b.
Nuwayra ُ at al-Buṭāḥ

Buzākha

Done: Ṭulayḥa walked
off the field, and the
tribes around him
came back

al-Buṭāḥ

Next in the orders: the
Tamīm country, and
Mālīk b. Nuwayra ُ

From Buzākha to al-Buṭāḥ



Buzākha

where evening 2 stopped

al-Buṭāḥ

the third stop in the orders

The Anṣār who would not march

قَدْ عَهِدَ إِلَيَّ أَنْ أَمْضِيَ، وَأَنَا الْأَمِيرُ ... فَأَنَا قَاصِدٌ إِلَى مَالِكٍ وَمَنْ مَعِيَ،
وَلَسْتُ أُكْرِهُهُمْ.

"He instructed me to go on, and I am the commander ... So I am making for Mālik, with whoever is with me — and I do not compel them."

Mālik b. Nuwayra ُ stands apart

إِلَّا مَا كَانَ مِنْ مَالِكِ بْنِ نُوَيْرَةَ فَإِنَّهُ مُتَحِيرٌ فِي أَمْرِهِ، مُتَنَحٍّ عَنِ

النَّاسِ

"— except for what was from Mālik b. Nuwayra, for he was perplexed about his own affair, keeping apart from the people."

"Disperse, and enter into this matter"

إِنَّا دُعِينَا إِلَى هَذَا الْأَمْرِ فَأَبْطَأْنَا عَنْهُ فَلَمْ نُفْلِحْ ... فَتَفَرَّقُوا وَادْخُلُوا فِي هَذَا
الْأَمْرِ

...we were called to this matter and we were slow to it and did not prosper ... Disperse, and enter into this matter.

The patrol could not agree

فشهد أبو قتادة – الحارث بن ربيعي الأنصاري – أنهم أقاموا الصلاة، وقال

آخرون: إنهم لم يُؤذّنوا ولا صلّوا

...Abū Qatāda al-Anṣārī — al-Ḥārith b. Rib‘ī — testified that they had established the prayer, and others said they had neither given the adhān nor prayed.

One night, four accounts

The cold night

al-Bidāya: the crier's "warm your prisoners" taken as an order to kill.
al-Kāmil: only warmth was meant

Summoned

al-Bidāya, "it is said": reproached over Sajāḥ and the zakāt, then an order to strike

Heard, then ordered

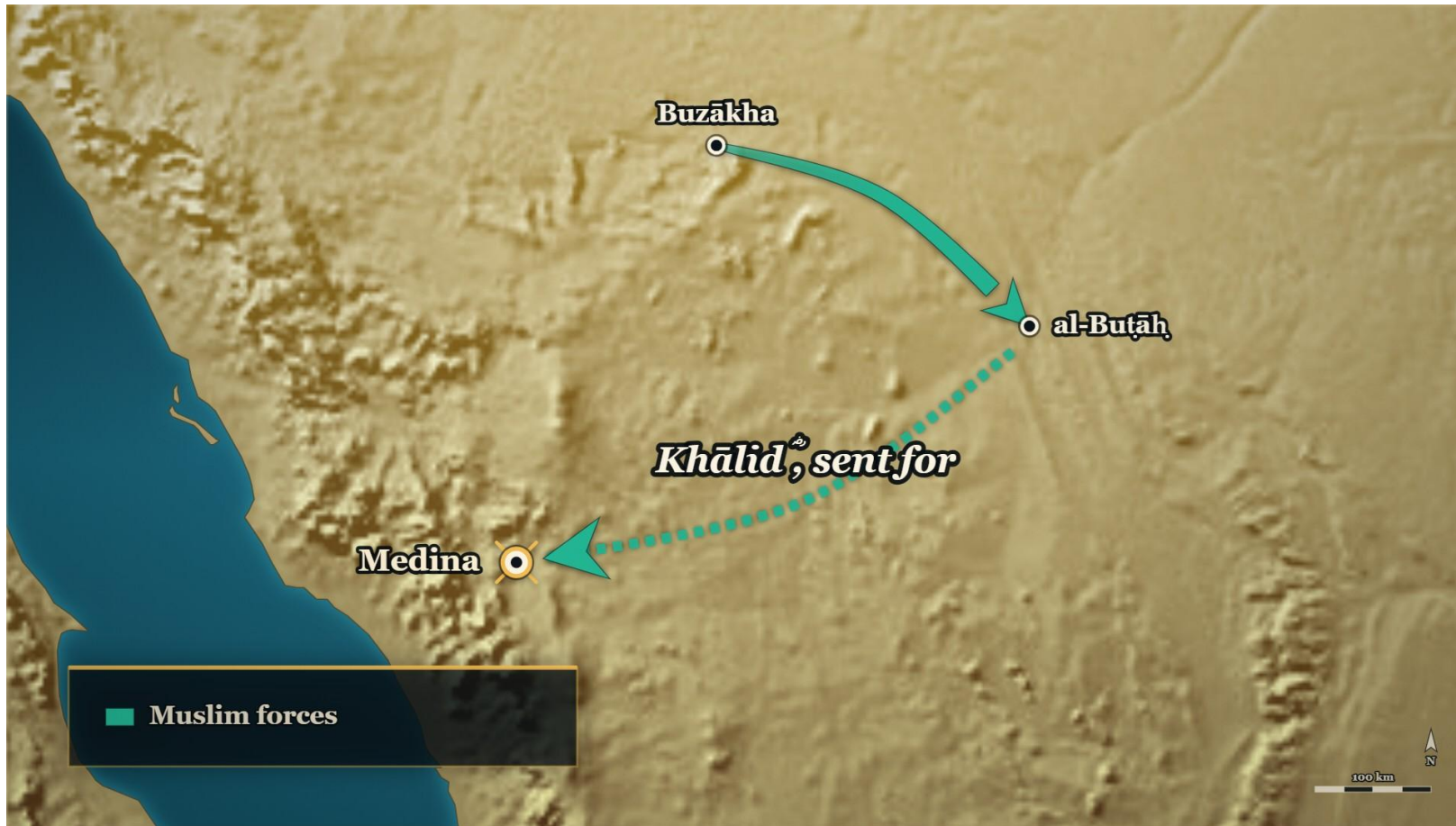
Siyar: Abū Qatāda ؓ spoke for him;
Khālid ؓ disliked what was said, and ordered the blow

Quarter given?

Siyar, from al-Zuhrī: arms laid down;
Abū Qatāda ؓ said quarter was given, the rest said not

Four accounts in the books. We record them, and we do not choose.

Back to Medina



To Medina

Khālīd ٱ is sent for

11 AH, Medina

‘Umar   in the mosque

أرياءً قتلَ امرأً مسلماً ثم نزوتَ على امرأته، والله لأرجمنك بالجنادل

"Was it for show? You killed a Muslim man, then you leapt upon his wife. By Allah, I will stone you with stones!"

"He interpreted, and he was mistaken"

هَيْه يَا عُمَرُ! تَأْوَلْ فَأَخْطَأَ، فَارْفَعْ لِسَانَكَ عَنْ خَالِدٍ، فَإِنِّي لَا أَشِيْمُ سَيْفًا سَلَّهُ
اللَّهُ عَلَى الْكَافِرِينَ.

"Enough, 'Umar! He interpreted and was mistaken. Lift your tongue off Khālid — for I do not sheathe a sword Allah has drawn against the disbelievers."

The historian's own verdict

واستمرَّ أبو بكر بخالدٍ على الإمرة، وإن كان قد اجتهد في قتلِ مالك بن نويرة
وأخطأ في قتله

"Abū Bakr continued with Khālid in command, even though he had exercised his judgement in the killing of Mālik b. Nuwayra and was mistaken in killing him."

‘Umar's ٱ caliphate

‘Umar ٱ and Mutammim

فَقَالَ مُتَمِّمٌ: ... لَوْ كَانَ أَخِي صُرِعَ مَصْرَعٌ أَخِيكَ لَمَّا بَكَيْتُهُ. فَقَالَ عُمَرُ: مَا
عَزَّانِي أَحَدٌ بِأَحْسَنَ

Mutammim said: ... had my brother fallen where your brother fell, I would not have wept for him. ‘Umar said: No one has ever consoled me better...

Part III

The road to al-Yamāma (11–12 AH)

Back to the mosque, 11 AH

al-Buṭāḥ

Mālik b. Nuwayra ُ
killed: a night the
books tell four ways

Medina

‘Umar ُ objects in the
mosque; Abū Bakrُ :
he interpreted, and
was mistaken

Next

One claimant still
standing: Musaylima,
at al-Yamāma

Out again, to al-Yamāma



To al-Yamāma
the army, and the
reserve behind it

Excused, and sent to al-Yamāma

لما رضي الصديقُّ عن خالد بن الوليد وعذْرُهُ بما اعتذرَ به، بعثه إلى قتالِ بني
حنيفة باليمامة

When the Ṣiddīq was satisfied with Khālīd b. al-Walīd and accepted the excuse he made, he sent him to fight Banū Ḥanīfa at al-Yamāma.

11 AH, before Khālīd ٱ arrived

Meanwhile, at al-Yamāma

One banner

Of the eleven banners,
‘Ikrima ٱ had the one
sent against
Musaylima

Behind him

Shuraḥbīl b. Ḥasanaٱ ,
sent to follow him

First there

Both reached al-
Yamāma before
Khālīd ٱ and the main
army

Two commanders sent ahead



‘Ikrima
beaten, then sent
on to Oman

Shuraḥbīl
halted on the road

‘Ikrima ٱ goes too early

لَا أَرِيَنَّكَ وَلَا تَرَاني، لَا تَرْجِعَنَّ فُتُوهِنَ النَّاسِ ... فَقَاتِلْ أَهْلَ عُمَانَ وَمَهْرَةَ

Let me not see you and do not you see me. Do not come back and weaken the people ... fight the people of ‘Umān and Mahra...

And then it happened again

وَعَجَّلَ شُرْحِبِيلُ بْنُ حَسَنَةَ، وَبَادَرَ خَالِدًا بِقِتَالِ مُسَيْلِمَةَ، فَنُكِبَ، فَلَامَهُ خَالِدٌ.

"Shuraḥbīl b. Ḥasana hurried, and got ahead of Khālīd in fighting Musaylima, and was struck down; and Khālīd reproached him."

‘Aqrabā’, and the ground behind it



‘Aqrabā’
the enemy camp

The farmland
behind their own
line

Forty thousand, and the ground he chose

فلما سمع مسيلمةُ بقدوم خالدٍ عسكر بمكانٍ يقال له: (عقربا) في طرف
اليمامة والريف وراءَ ظهورهم

"When Musaylima heard of Khālīd's coming, he encamped at a place called 'Aqrabā', at the edge of al-Yamāma, with the cultivated country behind their backs."

The tent and the prisoner

أيها الرجل إن كنت تريد بأهل اليمامة غدًا خيرًا أو شرًا فاستبق هذا الرجل

Man — if you intend anything tomorrow for the people of Yamāma, good or ill, keep this man alive...

Part IV

The day begins (11–12 AH)

The night before ‘Aqrabā’ Where we are

Medina

Khālīd ٱ answered for
al-Buṭāḥ, and was kept
in command

The road

‘Ikrima ٱ and
Shuraḥbīl ٱ beaten
ahead of him; forty
thousand at ‘Aqrabā’

The tent

A prisoner in irons in
Khālīd's ٱ own tent:
Mujjā‘a of Banū Ḥanīfa

11-12 AH — the books disagree

The order of battle

ورايةُ المهاجرين مع سالم ... ورايةُ الأنصار مع ثابت بن قيس ... والعرب

على راياتها

The Muhājirūn's banner was with Sālim ... the Anṣār's banner with Thābit b. Qays ... and the Arabs each under their own banners.

al-Bidaya wa'l-Nihaya, vol. 7, p. 33

11-12 AH — attribution disputed

"Today is the day of honour"

اليوم يوم الغيرة، اليوم إن هُزمتُم تُستنكح النساء سَبَيَّاتٍ ... فقاتلوا عن
أحسابكم، وامنعوا نساءكم.

Today is the day of honour. Today, if you are routed, the women will be taken as captives ... So fight for your own standing, and protect your women.

al-Bidaya wa'l-Nihaya, vol. 7, p. 33

11–12 AH, 'Aqrabā'

The line breaks, and the two protections

فكانت جولة ... حتى دخلت بنو حنيفة خيمة خالد بن الوليد وهمّوا بقتل أم
تميم، حتى أجارها مجاعة

*There was a rout ... Banū Ḥanīfa entered Khālīd b. al-Walīd's
own tent and were minded to kill Umm Tamīm — until Mujjā 'a
gave her his protection...*

al-Bidaya wa'l-Nihaya, vol. 7, p. 33

11–12 AH, 'Aqrabā'

The man who made the lie believable

فَكَانَ أَعْظَمَ فِتْنَةً عَلَى بَنِي حَنِيفَةَ مِنْ مُسَيْلِمَةَ ... فَصَدَّقُوهُ

وَاسْتَجَابُوا لَهُ

*He was a greater fitna upon Banū Ḥanīfa than Musaylima ...
and they believed him and answered him.*

"People of Sūrat al-Baqara"

وجعلت الصحابة يتواصون بينهم ويقولون: يا أصحاب سورة البقرة، بطل

السِّحْرُ اليوم

*"And the Companions began enjoining one another, saying:
People of Sūrat al-Baqara — today the sorcery is undone."*

11–12 AH, 'Aqrabā'

Thābit b. Qays ٱ puts on his shroud

هَكَذَا عَنْ وُجُوهِنَا نُقَارِعُ الْقَوْمَ ... مَا هَكَذَا كُنَّا نُقَاتِلُ مَعَ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ ﷺ.

Get out of our faces so we can strike the enemy ... This is not how we used to fight alongside the Messenger of Allah ﷺ.

"A wretched bearer of the Qur'ān"

أتخشى أن نؤتى من قبلك؟ فقال: بئس حامل القرآن أنا إذا.

...Do you fear we shall be broken from your side? He said: A wretched bearer of the Qur'ān I should be, then.

11–12 AH, 'Aqrabā'

Zayd b. al-Khaṭṭāb ؓ — "I will not speak"

والله لا أتكلّم حتى يهزمهم الله أو ألقى الله فأكلّمه بحجّتي

...By Allah, I will not speak until Allah routs them, or I meet Allah and speak to Him with my case.

The other wing: Abū Ḥudhayfaؓ

"Adorn the Qur'ān with deeds"

يا أَهْلَ الْقُرْآنِ زَيِّنُوا الْقُرْآنَ بِالْفِعَالِ

"People of the Qur'ān — adorn the Qur'ān with deeds."

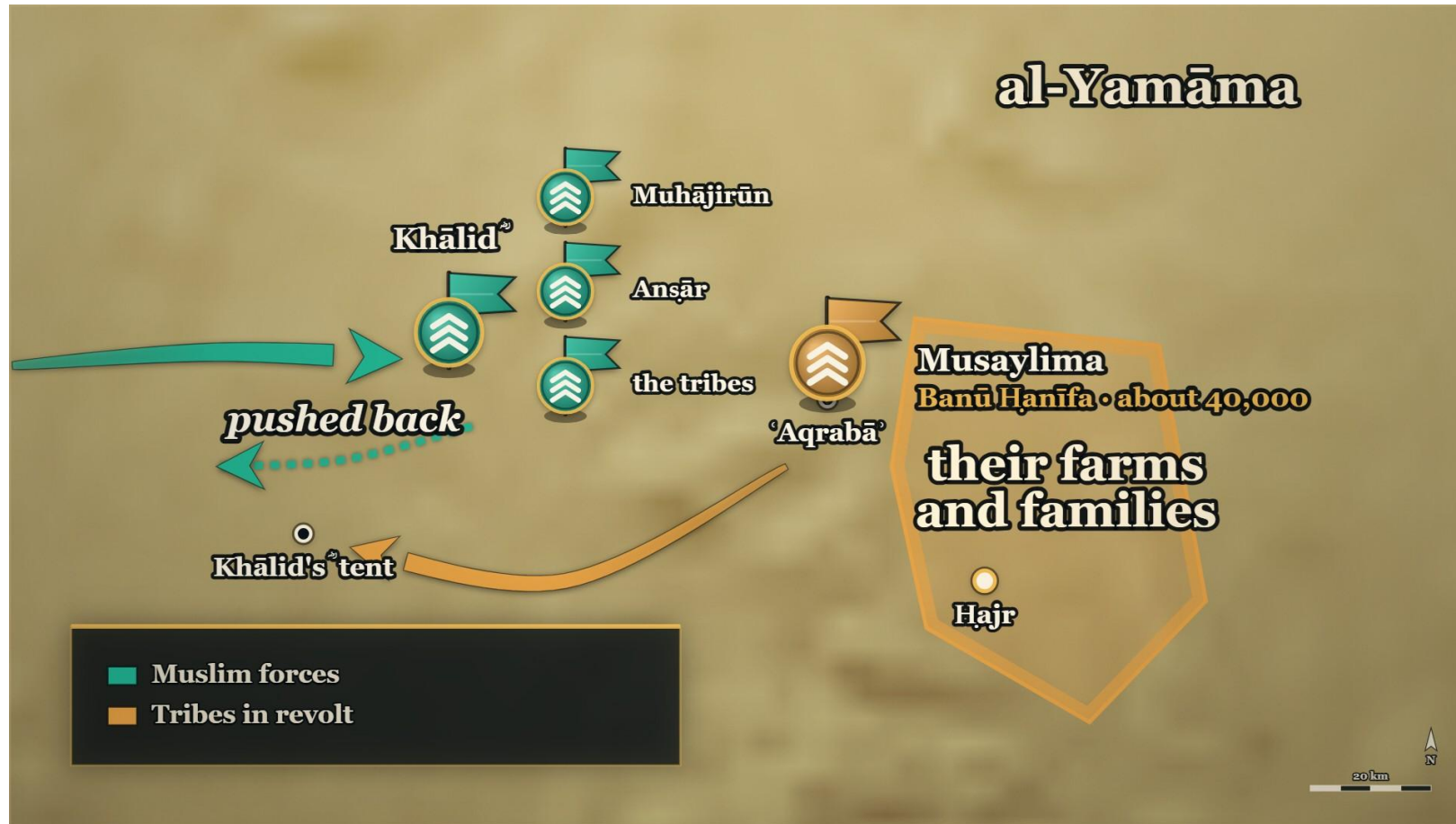
11–12 AH, ‘Aqrabā’

Khālīd ٱ between the lines

أنا ابن الوليد العَوْد، أنا ابن عامر وزيد ... وجعل لا يبرز لهم أحدٌ إلا قتله

I am the son of al-Walīd the seasoned; I am the son of ‘Āmir and Zayd ... and no one came out against him but he killed him.

The line re-formed



Clan by clan
Muhājirūn, Anṣār,
the tribes

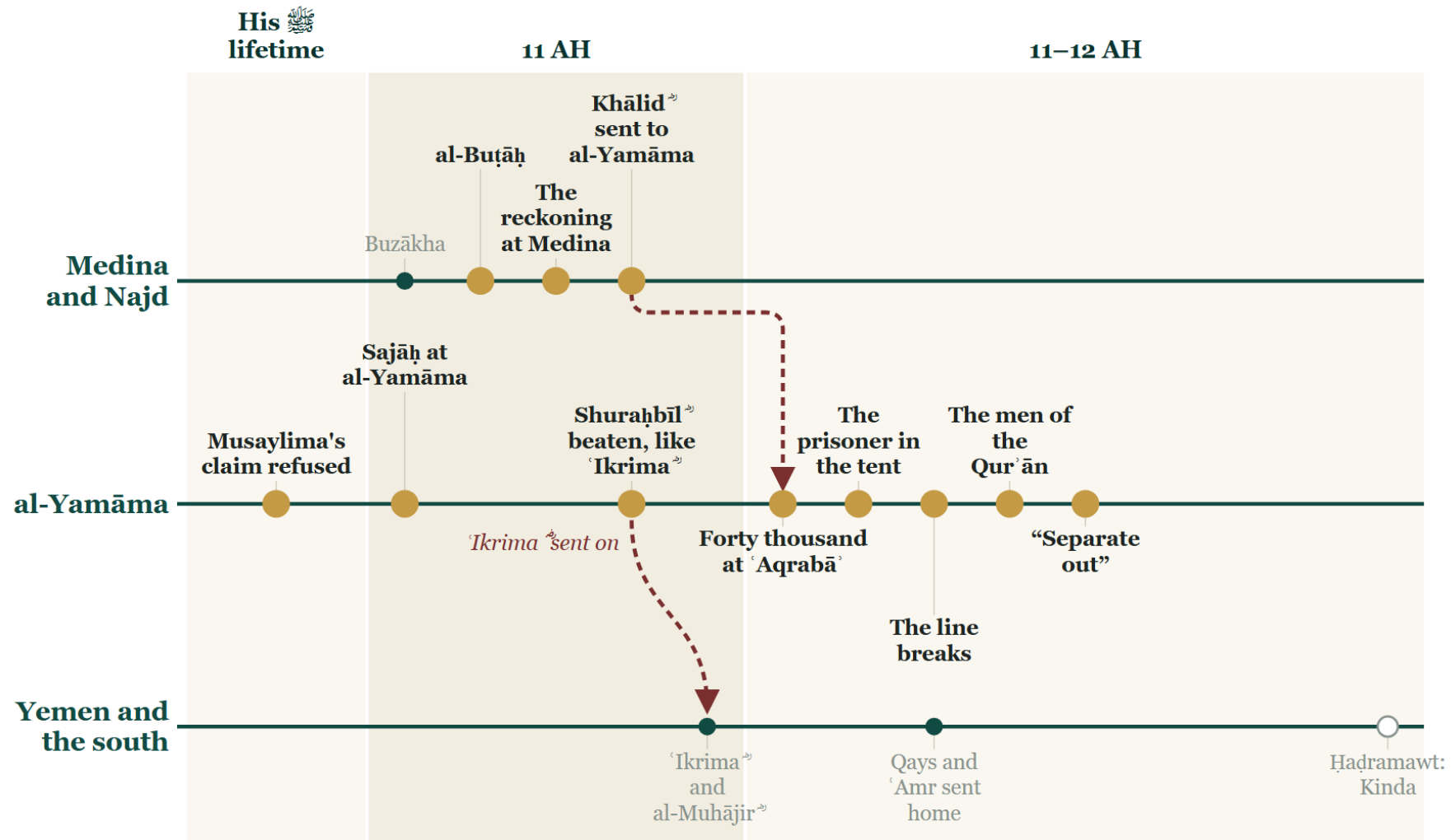
11–12 AH, 'Aqrabā'

Every clan under its own banner

امْتَازُوا أَيُّهَا النَّاسُ لِنَعْلَمَ بَلَاءَ كُلِّ حَيٍّ ... قَالَ بَعْضُهُمْ لِبَعْضٍ: الْيَوْمَ يُسْتَحَى
مِنَ الْفِرَارِ.

*Separate out, people, so we may know what each clan is worth
... they said to one another: Today, running is shameful.*

Tonight on the Line



Where we stand



‘**Aqrabā**’
the line re-formed

Ḥajr
the town behind
them

Tonight

- | One document divides the country between two tribes, and the other answers that the country belongs to neither of them.
- | The caliph said out loud that his commander had got it wrong, paid for it, and kept him. Those three are one decision, not three.
- | When the line broke, what re-formed it was what the men had memorised.
- | He did not make them braver; he made it impossible for anyone's failure to be anonymous.

Next week

The line has been re-formed and the day is not yet decided. Where does an army go when it cannot retreat?

Part V

The day decided

11–12 AH, 'Aqrabā'

Past the close: the day is decided

Where we stopped

The line re-formed,
every clan under its
own banner, and the
day undecided

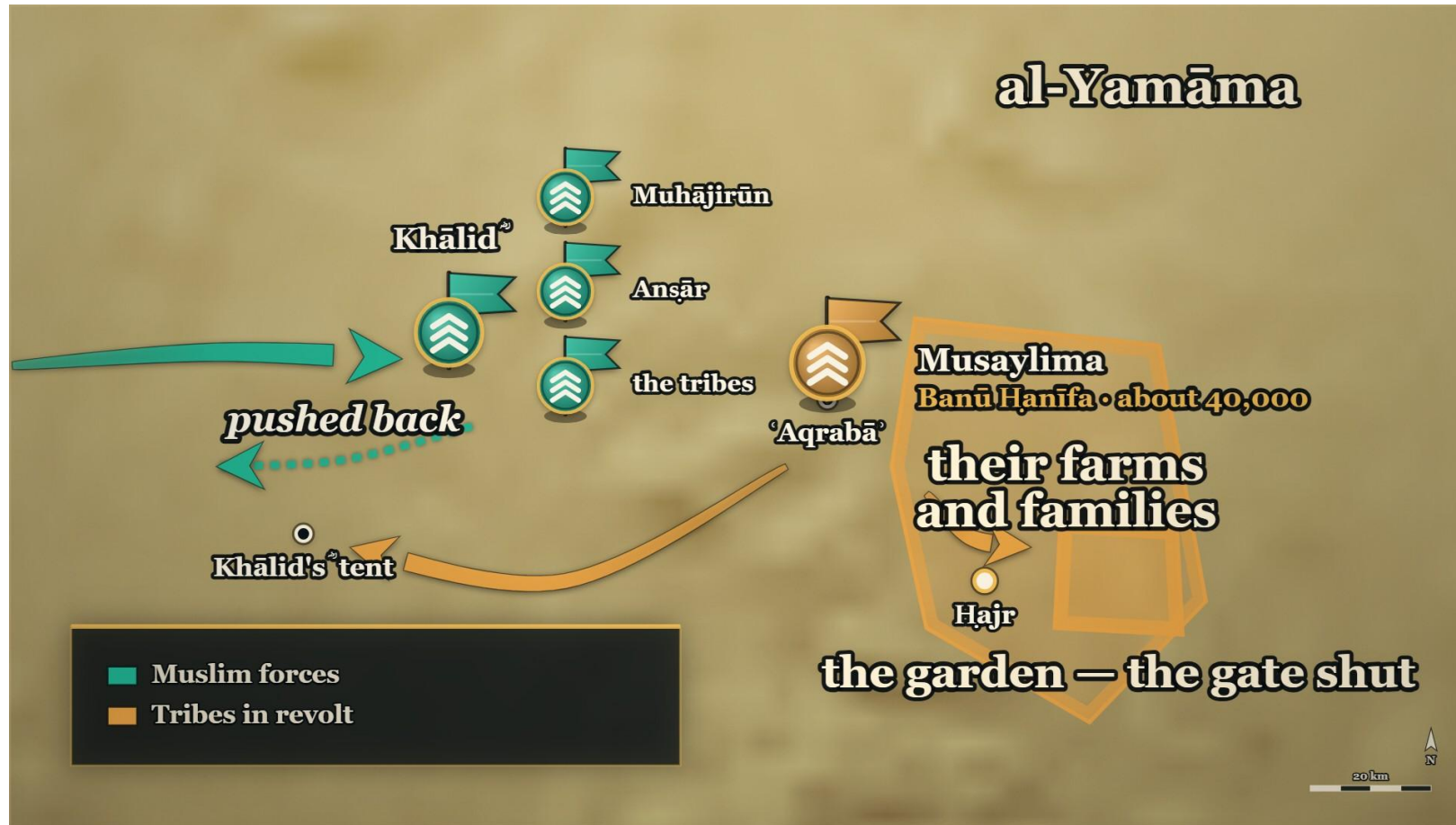
What happens next

Banū Ḥanīfa give way
— and fall back into a
walled garden

What this last part is

The garden, the end of
Musaylima, the terms
at the forts, and one
order at Medina

Into the garden



The garden
the gate shut
behind them

11–12 AH, 'Aqrabā'

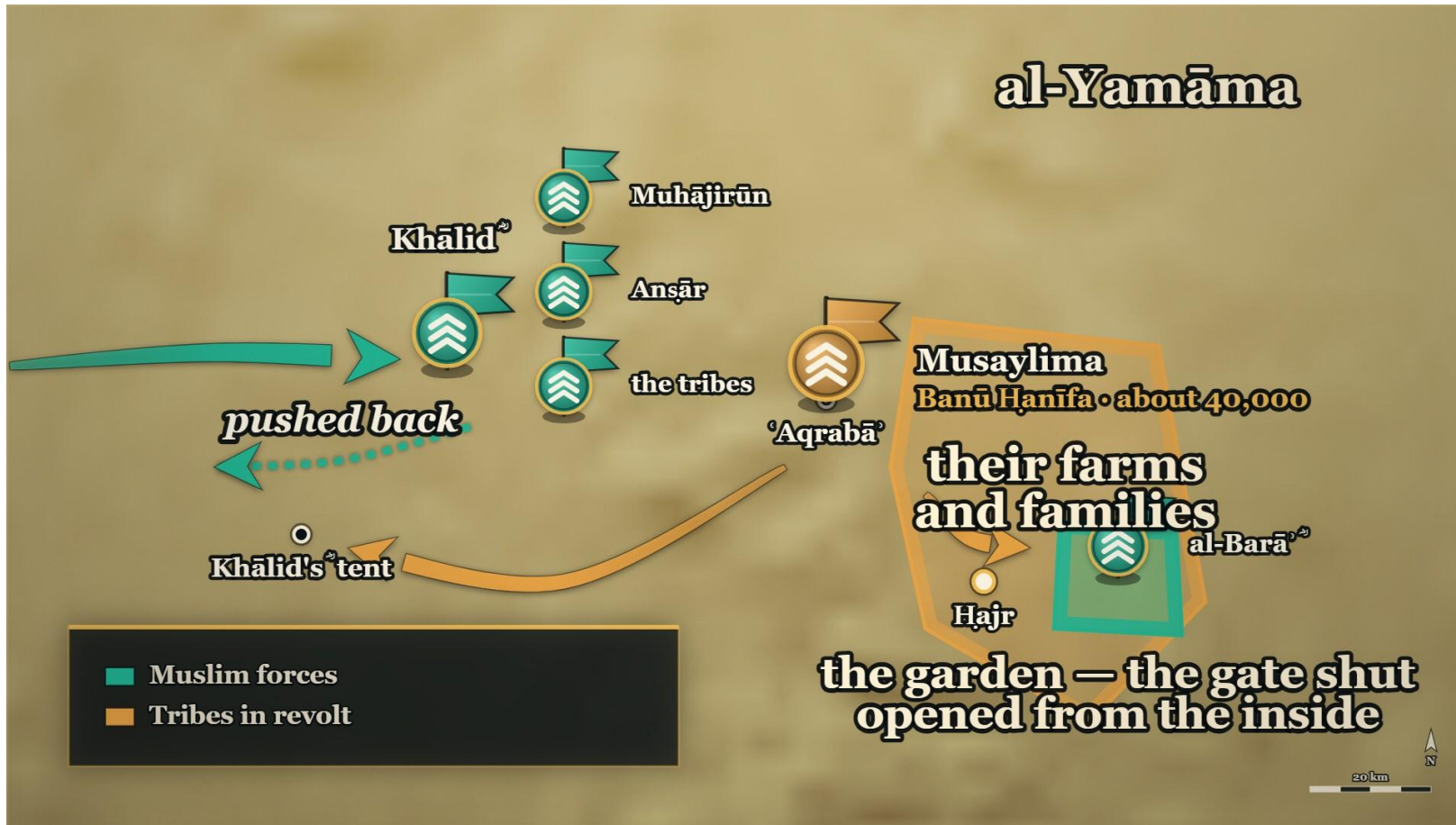
Ḥadīqat al-Mawt — over the wall

يَا مَعْشَرَ الْمُسْلِمِينَ، أَلقُونِي عَلَيْهِمْ فِي الْحَدِيقَةِ. فَقَالُوا: لَا نَفْعَلُ، فَقَالَ: وَاللَّهِ
لَتَطْرَحُنِي عَلَيْهِمْ بِهَا! ... وَقَاتَلَ عَلَى الْبَابِ وَفَتَحَهُ لِلْمُسْلِمِينَ.

"Company of Muslims — throw me over onto them into the garden. They said: we will not..."

al-Kamil, vol. 2, p. 218

The gate opens



al-Barā

over the wall, and
the gate

al-Yamāma

taken

11–12 AH, 'Aqrabā'

The death of Musaylima

وَعَنْ وَحْشِيٍّ، قَالَ: لَمْ أَرَ قَطُّ أَصْبَرَ عَلَى الْمَوْتِ مِنْ أَصْحَابِ مُسَيْلِمَةَ، ثُمَّ ذَكَرَ
أَنَّهُ شَارَكَ فِي قَتْلِ مُسَيْلِمَةَ.

"From Waḥshī: I never saw men more steadfast in the face of death than Musaylima's companions — then he mentioned that he had a share in killing Musaylima."

The treaty he was tricked into, and kept

وَوَصَلَ كِتَابُ أَبِي بَكْرٍ إِلَى خَالِدٍ أَنْ يَقْتُلَ كُلَّ مُحْتَلِمٍ ... فَوَفَّى لَهُمْ وَلَمْ يَغْدِرْ.

And Abū Bakr's letter reached Khālid, ordering him to kill every man who had reached puberty ... so he kept faith with them and did not betray them.

12 AH, Rabī' I

Zayd b. al-Khaṭṭāb ؓ and his brother

وَكَانَ يَقُولُ: أَسْلَمَ قَبْلِي، وَاسْتُشْهِدَ قَبْلِي ... وَكَانَ يَقُولُ: مَا هَبَّتِ الصَّبَا إِلَّا
وَأَنَا أَجِدُ رِيحَ زَيْدٍ.

"He used to say: He became Muslim before me and was martyred before me ... And he used to say: The east wind never blows but I find in it the scent of Zayd."

Siyar A'lam al-Nubala, vol. 1, p. 298

Part VI

The dead of al-Yamāma

11–12 AH, 'Aqrabā'

The men who did not come back

At the line

Sālim ٱ carried the
Muhājirūn's banner;
Zayd ٱ and Abū
Ḥudhayfa ٱ held the
wings

All three

Killed on that field, on
the same day

Still to tell

What happened at
that banner, and the
order it led to at
Medina

In the Prophet's ﷺ lifetime

Take the Qur'ān from four

قال فيهم رسول الله ﷺ: "استقرئوا القرآن من أربعة" فذكر منهم سالمًا مولى أبي

حذيفة

...of whom the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: 'Take the Qur'ān from four' — and he mentioned Sālim, the freedman of Abū Hudhayfa.

The hand, and the verse

... فاحتضنها وهو يقول: ﴿وَمَا مُحَمَّدٌ إِلَّا رَسُولٌ قَدْ خَلَتْ مِنْ

قَبْلِهِ الرُّسُلُ﴾

...so he clasped it to his chest, saying: ﴿Muḥammad is no more than a Messenger; messengers have passed away before him﴾.

"Lay me down between them"

ما فعل أبو حذيفة؟ قالوا: قُتِلَ ... قال: فأضجعوني بينهما

What has become of Abū Ḥudhayfa? They said: He has been killed ... He said: Then lay me down between the two of them.

12 AH, after al-Yamāma

It is said they were found together

وَقِيلَ: إِنَّ سَالِمًا وَجَدَ هُوَ وَمَوْلَاهُ أَبُو حُذَيْفَةَ، رَأْسُ أَحَدِهِمَا عِنْدَ رِجْلَيِ الْآخَرِ

صَرِيْعَيْنِ

And it is said: Sālim was found, he and his patron Abū Ḥudhayfa, the head of one of them at the feet of the other.

‘Umar's ُ caliphate, 13–23 AH

«Do not put al-Barā' over an army»

لَا تَسْتَغْمِلُوا الْبَرَاءَ عَلَى جَيْشٍ، فَإِنَّهُ مَهْلَكَةٌ مِنَ الْمَهَالِكِ يَقْدُمُ

بِهِم.

"Do not put al-Barā' in command of an army, for he is a destruction among destructions — he presses forward with them."

Siyar A'lam al-Nubala, vol. 1, p. 196

Undated

«Do you see me dying in my bed?»

أَتَرَانِي أَمُوتُ عَلَى فِرَاشِي؟ وَاللَّهِ لَقَدْ قَتَلْتُ بِضْعاً وَتِسْعِينَ.

"Do you see me dying in my bed? By Allah, I have killed ninety-odd."

Siyar A'lam al-Nubala, vol. 1, p. 198

12 AH, after the battle

The number nobody can give

وذلك بعد ما استَحَرَّ القتلُ في القُرَّاء يوم اليمامة كما ثبت به الحديث في
صحيح البخاري.

"...and that was after the killing had run hot among the reciters on the day of al-Yamāma, as the ḥadīth in Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī establishes."

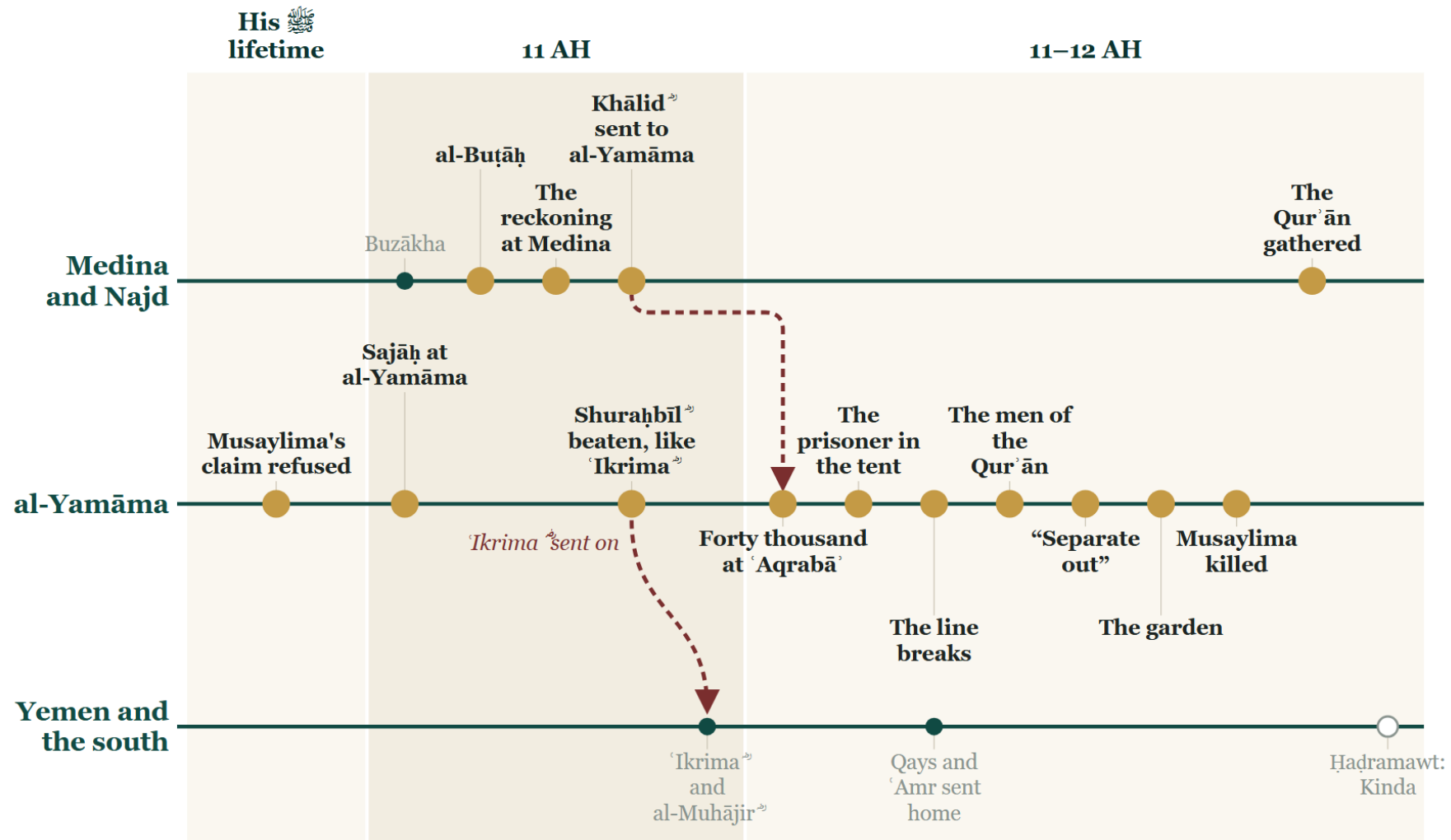
al-Bidaya wa'l-Nihaya, vol. 7, p. 79 — Sahih al-Bukhari 4986

The Qur'ān was collected because of this

أمر الصديق زيد بن ثابت أن يجمع القرآن من اللّخاف والعُصْب وصدور
الرجال

...al-Ṣiddīq ordered Zayd b. Thābit to gather the Qur'ān from the flat stones and the palm-stalks and the breasts of men.

Tonight on the Line



Where we stand



al-Yamāma
taken at last

Ḥadramawt
the last front

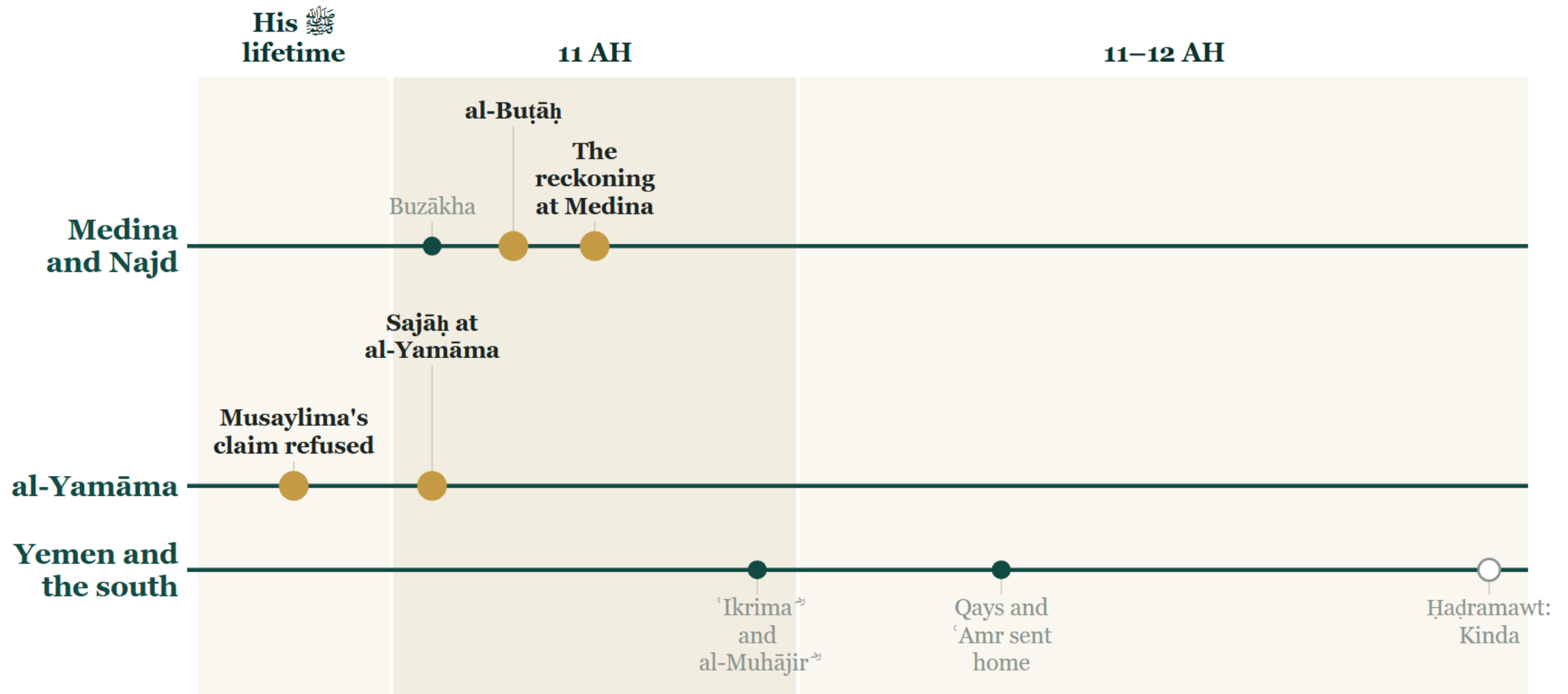
Tonight

- | When the line broke, what re-formed it was what the men had memorised.
- | One man asked to be thrown where nobody could follow him, and the whole army came in behind him through the gate he opened.
- | The verse that steadied Medina in the year eleven is the verse a man recited on the ground in the year twelve.
- | The mushaf the room reads from was gathered because of the men who were killed in the garden.

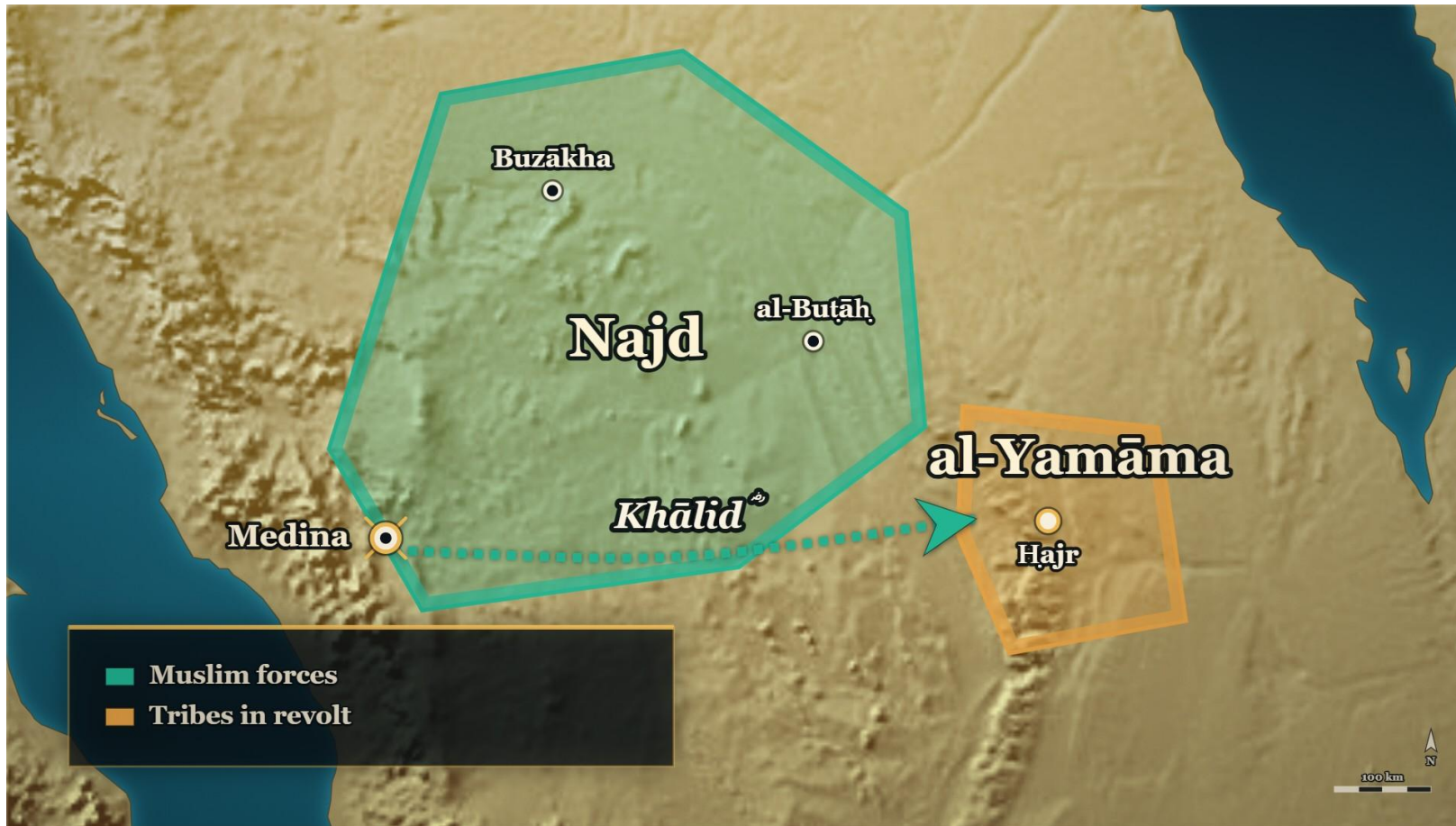
Next week

One province on your map is still grey.
The last front of the war is Ḥaḍramawt —
and it begins with a quarrel over one she-
camel.

Tonight on the Line



Where we stand



Najd

Buzākha and al-Butāḥ behind him

al-Yamāma

still in revolt

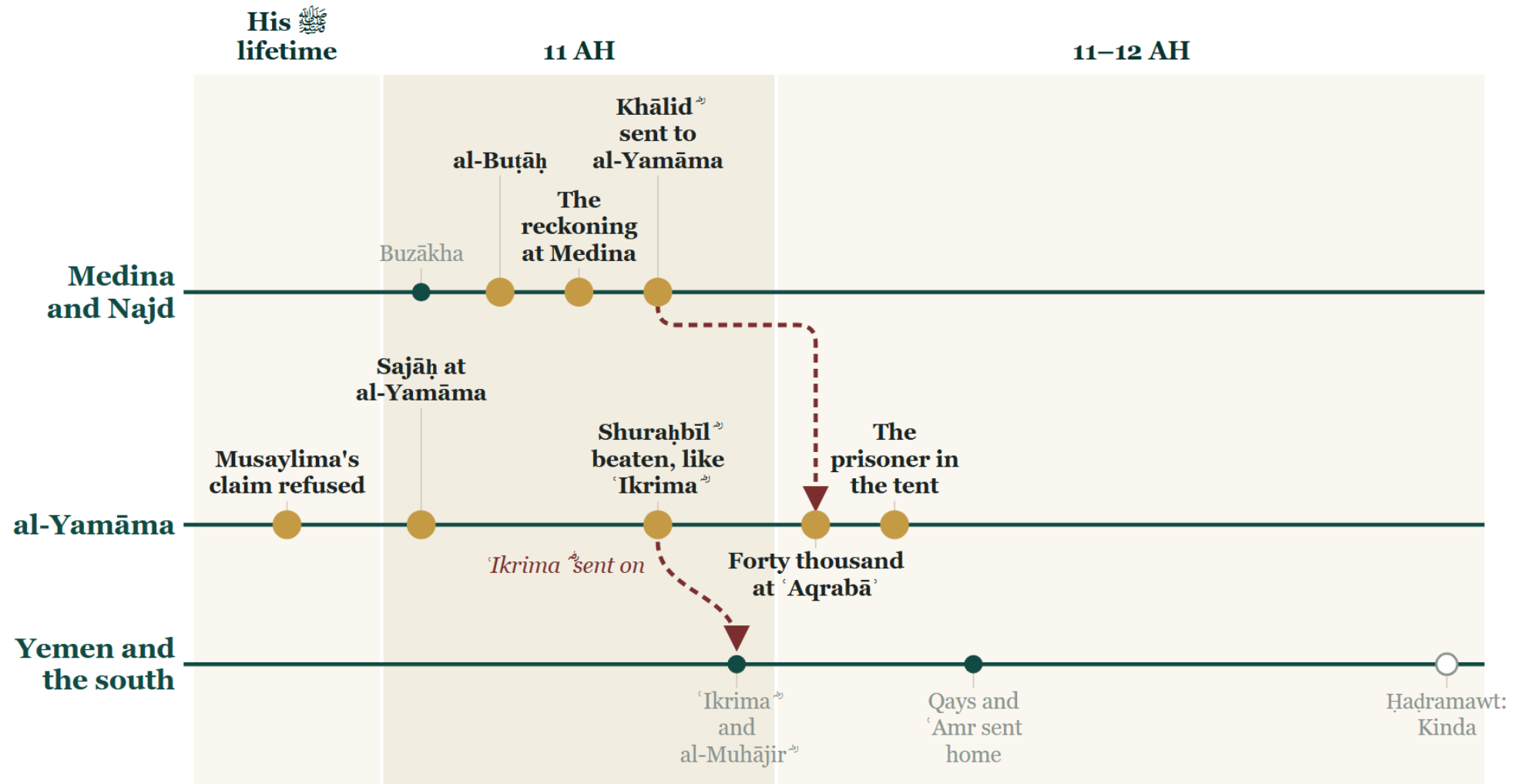
Tonight

- | One document divides the country between two tribes, and the other answers that the country belongs to neither of them.
- | Two men can stand in the same place at the same hour and carry away two different nights.
- | The caliph said out loud that his commander had got it wrong, paid for it, and kept him. Those three are one decision, not three.
- | The quarrel is not closed by a verdict. It is closed by two bereaved men consoling each other.

Next week

Khālīd ٱ keeps his command, and the last claimant is waiting in al-Yamāma with forty thousand men. What happens when the army reaches him?

Tonight on the Line



Where we stand



al-Yamāma
the armies in
position

Najd
settled behind them

Tonight

- | One document divides the country between two tribes, and the other answers that the country belongs to neither of them.
- | Two men can stand in the same place at the same hour and carry away two different nights.
- | The caliph said out loud that his commander had got it wrong, paid for it, and kept him. Those three are one decision, not three.
- | He was not dismissed for the defeat; he was given more ground to cross.

Next week

There is a man in irons in Khālīd's ٥ own tent. Next week he saves a life, and then a life is saved for him.